

Here are 12 varied, classroom-friendly use cases designed to make students practice breaking a complex task into a chain of smaller, checkable steps.

1. Plan a weekend trip under a fixed budget
Goal: 2-day trip for 3 people, <\$600 total.
2. Diagnose a sudden website traffic drop
Goal: Find likely cause and next actions.
3. Create a meal plan for 5 days with dietary constraints
Goal: 5 dinners, <700 kcal each, vegetarian + nut-free.
4. Grade a short-answer exam consistently
Goal: Apply a 0–3 rubric fairly across 20 answers.
5. Choose a vendor for a software tool
Goal: Pick 1 of 3 vendors for an analytics platform.
6. Triage a customer-support backlog
Goal: Clear 100 tickets; minimize churn risk.
7. Clean and normalize a messy CSV for analysis
Goal: Produce analysis-ready table.
8. Explain a multi-step math word problem (rate/mixture)
Goal: Derive the correct numeric answer with justification.
9. Draft a performance review with evidence
Goal: Balanced review with concrete examples and goals.
10. Plan a classroom activity with timeboxing
Goal: 45-minute active learning exercise.

11. Debug a failing data pipeline

Goal: Restore a nightly ETL that stopped succeeding.

12. Decompose a crossword-style puzzle solving strategy

Goal: Teach a general approach (not solving a specific grid).

Tips you can give students for each task

- Start with “Clarify & constraints.” Write them down first.
- Turn vague goals into checkable criteria.
- Prefer “extract → transform → decide → verify” over jumping to answers.
- Add a final “sanity/risks” step before presenting the result.